Dashboard Engine User Input and Update Guide

How to run the HTML dashboard generator and answer every runtime question

Prepared for Treasury Reporting process documentation

Primary source reviewed: BS EXPOSURE & VARIANCE ANALYSIS HTML DASHBOARD ENGINE - EXECUTABLE SCRIPT (1).py

Language: English

Design intent: professional PDF handover for operational and maintenance use

This documentation was prepared from the supplied dashboard engine script. It explains what the engine does, what inputs it requires, how the runtime prompts work, how the HTML dashboard is assembled, and where maintenance attention is most likely to be needed.

Contents

1. Guide Purpose
2. What This Engine Produces
3. Before You Run the Engine
4. Questions the User Sees in Exact Order
5. How to Answer Each Question
6. Why the Engine Asks These Questions
7. Operational Workflow Diagram
8. Question-to-Outcome Navigation Map
9. Input Checklist
10. How to Validate the HTML Output
11. Common Errors and What They Usually Mean
12. Maintenance Gate and Future-Dated Reporting
13. Practical Run Example

1. Guide Purpose

This guide is written for the business user who runs the dashboard engine. It explains the exact prompts shown by the script, what each answer should look like, why each answer matters, and how to confirm that the generated HTML dashboard is usable before sharing it.

2. What This Engine Produces

The engine generates one local HTML dashboard file. That file contains three navigable pages: Executive Summary, Entity Level Exposure Details, and Variance Account Movement. The file is saved to Desktop and then opened automatically in the default browser.

3. Before You Run the Engine

- Make sure you have one combined Excel workbook that already contains BALANCE_SHEET_EXPOSURE_BI_DATA and VARIANCE_MOVEMENTS_BI_DATA.
- Make sure the workbook is the final BI-ready source, not a raw extract.
- Make sure the file path is known and accessible from the machine where you run the engine.
- Make sure your reporting period is clear before starting because the answer is used in the output filename and the maintenance check.

Pre-run file expectation

This engine does not ask for separate exposure and variance files. It expects one workbook that already merges both datasets.

4. Questions the User Sees in Exact Order

Step	Exact user-facing prompt	What the user should provide
1	Press ENTER to create the Balance Sheet Exposure & Variance Analysis Report...	User simply presses Enter to continue.
2	Which year and month are you updating the report for? (e.g. 2025 December, Dec 2025, 2025-12)	Provide a year and month expression such as '2025 December', 'Decembe
3	Please provide the file path to the master data Excel workbook:	Paste the full path to the Excel workbook that contains both BI tabs. Quotec

5. How to Answer Each Question

5.1 Startup confirmation

Prompt shown by the engine: Press ENTER to create the Balance Sheet Exposure & Variance Analysis Report...

Recommended answer: User simply presses Enter to continue.

Why this matters: This is a soft start gate. It confirms the operator is ready and prevents accidental execution from immediately launching the full workflow.

5.2 Reporting period

Prompt shown by the engine: Which year and month are you updating the report for? (e.g. 2025 December, Dec 2025, 2025-12)

Recommended answer: Provide a valid year-month expression such as '2025 December', 'December 2025', '2025-12', or '12/2025'.

Why this matters: The answer drives three things: period validation, the maintenance gate, and the output file naming pattern BALANCE_SHEET_EXPOSURE_VARIANCE_ANALYSIS_.html.

Examples of valid reporting period answers

- 2025 December
- December 2025
- 2025 Dec
- Dec 2025
- 2025-12
- 12/2025

5.3 Master workbook path

Prompt shown by the engine: Please provide the file path to the master data Excel workbook:

Recommended answer: Paste the full path to the Excel workbook that contains both BI tabs. Quoted paths are accepted because the script strips surrounding single or double quotes.

Why this matters: The script needs one consolidated source workbook. It does not ask for separate Balance Sheet Exposure and Variance files; both datasets must already be present inside one workbook.

Examples of acceptable path formats

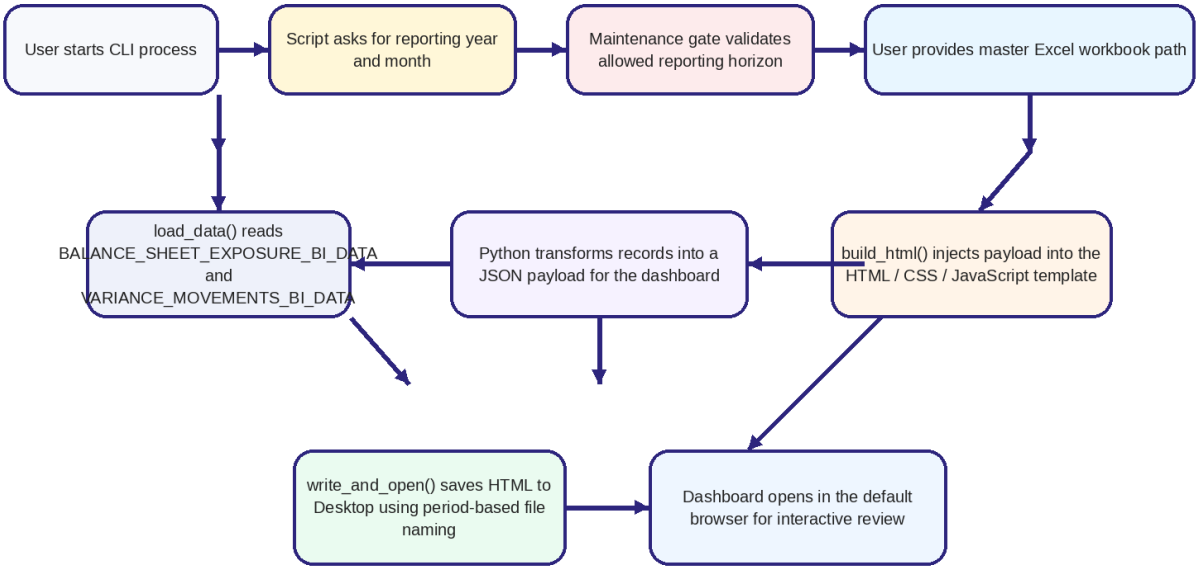
- C:\Users\\Desktop\MASTER_DATA_FILE.xlsx
- "C:\Users\\OneDrive - Company\Reports\MASTER_DATA_FILE.xlsx"
- /Users//Desktop/MASTER_DATA_FILE.xlsx

6. Why the Engine Asks These Questions

Prompt	Why the engine needs it
Press ENTER	Acts as a human confirmation gate before the dashboard generation starts.
Reporting period	Used for period validation, compliance maintenance control, and HTML file naming.
Master workbook path	Required to locate the source workbook that already contains both BI sheets used in the dashboard.

7. Operational Workflow Diagram

DASHBOARD ENGINE - END-TO-END PROCESS FLOW

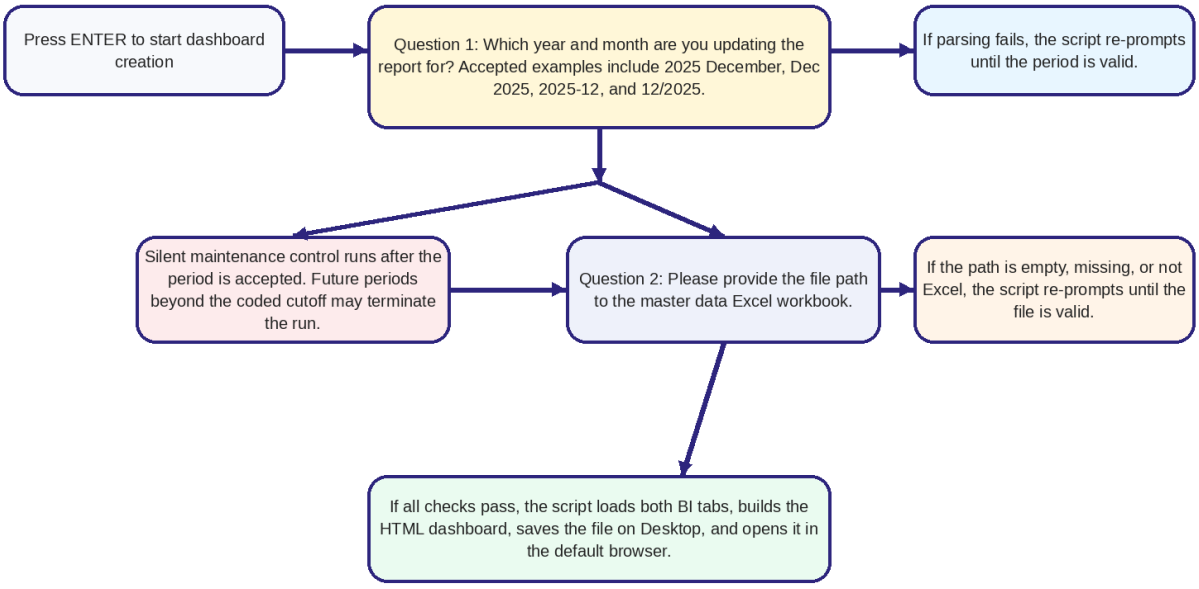


Key idea: the engine does not create source data. It consumes the master workbook created by the Balance Sheet Exposure and Variance Analysis processes, transforms both tabs into one browser-ready payload, and publishes a local HTML dashboard.

Read this as the engine lifecycle. Once the user passes the small runtime input stage, the remainder of the process is automated.

8. Question-to-Outcome Navigation Map

USER QUESTION AND ANSWER NAVIGATION



This map is useful for training and troubleshooting because it shows the two places where the script can reprompt: invalid reporting period answers and invalid file paths.

9. Input Checklist

Checkpoint	Yes/No question the user should ask before running
Workbook assembled	Do I have one workbook with both required BI tabs?
File path known	Can I copy and paste the exact file path without guessing?
Reporting period known	Do I know the correct year-month I am publishing for?
Environment ready	Can this machine open local HTML files in a browser?

10. How to Validate the HTML Output

- Confirm that the HTML file was saved on Desktop with the correct reporting period in the filename.
- Confirm that the browser opens automatically.
- Confirm that the page navigation buttons work: Executive Summary, Entity Level Exposure Details, and Variance Account Movement.
- Confirm that the filter bar is visible and responsive.
- Confirm that charts actually render rather than showing blank areas.
- Confirm that KPI cards show numbers rather than placeholder dashes.
- Confirm that Page 3 variance detail rows are populated.

If any of these checks fail, the most likely causes are wrong source workbook structure, missing required columns, or missing access to external CDN assets.

11. Common Errors and What They Usually Mean

Observed behaviour	Likely cause	Recommended action
The script keeps asking for the reporting period	The period text cannot be parsed.	Use one of the documented formats such as 2025 December or 2025-12.
The script keeps asking for the workbook path again	The path is wrong, incorrect, or not an Excel file.	Paste the full path and confirm the file extension is xlsx, xlsm, or xls.
The script exits after the period prompt	The silent maintenance gate may have been triggered for a future or expired period.	Use a recent approved period or request an updated compiled version of the tool.
The browser opens but charts are blank	The local environment may not have loaded Chart.js or other CDN assets.	Check network access or modify the tool to package assets locally.
The script fails while loading Excel	One or both required tabs or columns are missing.	Rebuild the source workbook using the upstream Balance Sheet Exposure a

12. Maintenance Gate and Future-Dated Reporting

The script includes a silent maintenance cutoff after October 2026. If the user enters a reporting period beyond that cutoff, the code can exit if the hidden confirmation condition is not satisfied within a short window.

User-level interpretation

- If the engine exits unexpectedly for a future period, do not assume the workbook is wrong first.
- Check whether the requested period is beyond the coded maintenance horizon.
- If yes, the correct action is usually to request an updated maintained build of the engine.

13. Practical Run Example

Example scenario: the user wants to publish the dashboard for December 2025.

Runtime step	Example answer
Press ENTER	Enter key only
Reporting period	2025 December
Master workbook path	C:\Users\Analyst\Desktop\FX_BSEXP_VAIRNACE_BI_DATA_31122025.xlsx

Expected result: the engine builds an HTML file with a name similar to BALANCE_SHEET_EXPOSURE_VARIANCE_ANALYSIS_2025_DECEMBER.html, stores it on Desktop, and opens it in the browser.